

Backup and Data Recovery Policy

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1. Purpose

This policy explains what data Zuqah Technologies backs up, how frequently, how long backups are retained, and how to request the recovery of lost or accidentally deleted data.

2. What is backed up

2.1 Company systems (backed up automatically)

System	Backup frequency	Retention
OneDrive (all employee files)	Continuous version history	93 days of version history
SharePoint team sites	Daily	90 days
Microsoft Exchange (email)	Continuous	14-day deleted item recovery; 30-day litigation hold
Company databases (HR system, internal tools)	Daily full + 4-hourly incremental	30 days daily; 12 months monthly
Code repositories (GitHub)	Daily mirror to separate storage	90 days
Server infrastructure	Daily snapshot	30 days

2.2 What is NOT backed up

Item	Why	What to do
Files stored only on your laptop's local drive	Local storage is not included in cloud backup	Store all working files in OneDrive
Files stored on USB drives or external hard disks	External storage is not in scope	Store in OneDrive instead
Personal email accounts (Gmail, personal Outlook)	Not company systems	Back up personally
Unsaved work in applications	Cannot be backed up	Save frequently; enable AutoSave in Office apps

The single most important habit: Save your work to OneDrive, not to "Desktop" or "My Documents" on the local drive. If your laptop fails, only OneDrive files are guaranteed recoverable.

3. OneDrive version history

Every OneDrive file has automatic version history. You can recover a previous version of a file without contacting IT.

How to access version history:

- 1. Right-click the file in OneDrive (browser or desktop app)
- 2. Select "Version history"
- 3. Choose the version you want to restore and click "Restore"

Versions are kept for 93 days. Older versions are automatically deleted.

4. Recovering deleted files

4.1 Files deleted from OneDrive

Files deleted from OneDrive go to the OneDrive Recycle Bin and remain there for 93 days before permanent deletion.

How to recover:

- 1. Open OneDrive in a browser
- 2. Click "Recycle bin" in the left panel
- 3. Select the file or folder and click "Restore"

4.2 Emails deleted from Outlook

Deleted emails go to the Deleted Items folder. Items deleted from Deleted Items go to the Recoverable Items folder, where they remain for 14 days.

How to recover:

- 1. In Outlook, go to Deleted Items
- 2. Right-click and select "Recover Deleted Items from Server"
- 3. Select the email and click "Restore Selected Items"

4.3 Files permanently deleted (beyond Recycle Bin)

If a file has been permanently deleted (emptied from the Recycle Bin), IT may be able to restore it from the backup within the retention period.

5. Requesting data recovery from IT

For data that cannot be self-recovered from version history or the Recycle Bin:

Raise an IT request:

- 1. Log in to the IT portal at it.zuqahtechologies.com
- 2. Open a ticket: Storage & Files → Data Recovery Request

- 3. Provide:

- The file name and location (e.g., the OneDrive folder path) - The approximate date the file last existed in the correct state - Why the file needs to be recovered (accidentally deleted, corrupted, etc.)

Response times:

Priority	Scenario	Response time
High	Critical business data required for live work	4 business hours
Normal	Important file, work can continue without it	1 business day
Low	Historical data, not immediately needed	3 business days

Note: Recovery is not guaranteed, particularly for data deleted more than 30 days ago or data that was never in a backed-up location.

6. Laptop failure or replacement

If your laptop fails and needs to be replaced:

- All files in OneDrive will be automatically synced to your new laptop when you sign in
- Locally installed applications will need to be reinstalled by IT
- Settings and browser bookmarks synced to a Microsoft or browser account will be restored automatically

This is why storing files in OneDrive, not the local drive, is essential.

7. Ransomware and accidental mass deletion

If you suspect your computer has been infected with ransomware, or if a large number of files have been accidentally deleted or changed:

- 1. Disconnect your laptop from the network immediately (disable WiFi, unplug Ethernet)
- 2. Call the IT Security team immediately: security@zuqahtechnologies.com
- 3. Do not attempt to recover files yourself — IT will guide the process

OneDrive's version history means that even if ransomware encrypts your local files, clean copies are often recoverable from the cloud version history.

8. Employee responsibilities

To ensure your data is protected:

- Save all work files to OneDrive, not the local drive
- Enable AutoSave in Microsoft Office applications
- Empty the OneDrive Recycle Bin infrequently — do not delete files from

the Recycle Bin unless you are certain they are no longer needed

- Do not store sensitive data on USB drives or personal storage (see Data Classification Policy)

9. Contact

Self-service recovery: OneDrive version history and Recycle Bin (no IT involvement needed)

IT-assisted recovery: it.zuqahtechnologies.com — raise a ticket

Security incidents (ransomware, mass deletion): security@zuqahtechnologies.com

Sample content for demonstration purposes. Zuqah Technologies is a fictional company and this document describes no real organisation's policy.